Cloud features in action - complete text version

Customers rarely ask for “elasticity” or “uptime”. They describe a business situation, and part of your job is to recognise which cloud feature answers it. In this activity you will read four short business scenarios, decide which core cloud features stand out in each, point to the sentence that shows each feature, and then match four customer needs to the feature that best meets them. For each scenario, first choose the features that stand out. Then find the sentence in the scenario that shows each feature you chose. If a choice is not right, the feedback explains why and you can try again. The scenarios are short, so choose only what the text supports. Finally, match the customer needs to cloud features. The businesses are fictional. This activity is not scored, and nothing you choose or write is stored or sent anywhere unless you save a text file yourself. Allow about 15 minutes.

How to use this version

You can do every stage on paper or in a document. Read each scenario, choose the features you think stand out, then find the sentence that shows each one. Read the feedback for every option and compare it with your choices. If you chose differently, work out why before moving on. At the end, match each customer need to a feature.

The six core features

Six core cloud features, and what each one means. Keep these in mind as you read.

- Elasticity: Computing power can be added or removed as demand changes, helping a service handle sudden spikes and then reduce resources afterwards.
- Scalability: Storage and processing capacity can be increased to handle more demand, such as business growth over time.
- Pay-as-you-go pricing: Charges are based on the resources you use, so costs can track usage more closely than buying fixed infrastructure upfront.
- Uptime: Uptime is the proportion of time a service is available. Resilient design can help keep a service available when a component fails.
- Global access: Customers and teams can access services from different locations and regions, where that service is provided.
- Resource pooling: Shared resources are used across many customers so capacity can be allocated efficiently.

Scenario 1 of 4: Jin Cloud Solutions

Jin Cloud Solutions provides secure cloud infrastructure for growing businesses. A client’s new app suddenly gains millions of users. Jin Cloud automatically adds computing power to meet demand, then scales down later, keeping performance steady. The client pays only for the capacity it uses, so costs stay low.

A. Which core cloud features stand out? Select all that apply.

- Elasticity - Stands out. Feedback: That fits. The platform automatically adjusts computing power as usage changes, keeping services reliable during a spike.
- Pay-as-you-go pricing - Stands out. Feedback: That fits. The business pays only for the extra capacity it uses, avoiding high upfront infrastructure costs.
- Resource pooling - Does not stand out. Feedback: Not quite. Shared resources can help balance workloads across clients, but that is not the main feature shown here.
- Uptime - Does not stand out. Feedback: Not quite. This evidence is about elasticity: computing power increases to meet demand and scales down later. Uptime is about how long a service stays available.

B. Find the evidence

Now find the evidence. Choose the sentence that best shows each feature you identified. Which sentence shows elasticity?

- Jin Cloud Solutions provides secure cloud infrastructure for growing businesses. - Not the best fit. This is background about the company. It does not describe how the platform behaves.
- A client’s new app suddenly gains millions of users. - Not the best fit. This is the demand spike. It tells you why a feature is needed, not which feature the platform provides.
- Jin Cloud automatically adds computing power to meet demand, then scales down later, keeping performance steady. - Best fit. That fits. Computing power is added automatically and then removed when demand falls.
- The client pays only for the capacity it uses, so costs stay low. - Not the best fit. This sentence shows pay-as-you-go pricing: The client pays for the capacity it uses and nothing more.

Which sentence shows pay-as-you-go pricing?

- Jin Cloud Solutions provides secure cloud infrastructure for growing businesses. - Not the best fit. This is background about the company. It does not describe how the platform behaves.
- A client’s new app suddenly gains millions of users. - Not the best fit. This is the demand spike. It tells you why a feature is needed, not which feature the platform provides.

- Jin Cloud automatically adds computing power to meet demand, then scales down later, keeping performance steady. - Not the best fit. This sentence shows elasticity: Computing power is added automatically and then removed when demand falls.
- The client pays only for the capacity it uses, so costs stay low. - Best fit. That fits. The client pays for the capacity it uses and nothing more.

Scenario 2 of 4: Silverpath Outfitters

Silverpath Outfitters designs and sells casual apparel through its online store. During major sales, its cloud-based platform stays available the whole time, automatically switching to backup servers. Customers around the world can shop from anywhere, at any time, with the same experience.

A. Which core cloud features stand out? Select all that apply.

- Uptime - Stands out. Feedback: That fits. The online store stays available at all times, even when it has to switch to backup servers.
- Global access - Stands out. Feedback: That fits. The scenario says customers around the world can shop from anywhere, at any time, which shows global access.
- Elasticity - Does not stand out. Feedback: Not quite. “Major sales” may suggest busy periods, but nothing in the text says capacity is added or removed. The scenario emphasises other features.
- Resource pooling - Does not stand out. Feedback: Not quite. Resource pooling spreads workloads efficiently, but it is not the main focus of this situation.

B. Find the evidence

Now find the evidence. Choose the sentence that best shows each feature you identified. Which sentence shows uptime?

- Silverpath Outfitters designs and sells casual apparel through its online store. - Not the best fit. This is background about the company. It does not describe how the platform behaves.
- During major sales, its cloud-based platform stays available the whole time, automatically switching to backup servers. - Best fit. That fits. The store stays available because it switches to backup servers.
- Customers around the world can shop from anywhere, at any time, with the same experience. - Not the best fit. This sentence shows global access: Customers connect from anywhere and get the same experience.

Which sentence shows global access?

- Silverpath Outfitters designs and sells casual apparel through its online store. - Not the best fit. This is background about the company. It does not describe how the platform behaves.

- During major sales, its cloud-based platform stays available the whole time, automatically switching to backup servers. - Not the best fit. This sentence shows uptime: The store stays available because it switches to backup servers.
- Customers around the world can shop from anywhere, at any time, with the same experience. - Best fit. That fits. Customers connect from anywhere and get the same experience.

Scenario 3 of 4: Patternmaster Strategies

Patternmaster Strategies helps companies optimise operations through data analytics. Its cloud-hosted dashboards run on shared servers that balance workloads, keeping costs efficient through pooled computing resources. Clients worldwide get smooth performance from the same platform.

A. Which core cloud features stand out? Select all that apply.

- Resource pooling - Stands out. Feedback: That fits. The dashboards use shared servers and pooled computing resources across clients, which is resource pooling.
- Global access - Stands out. Feedback: That fits. The analytics dashboards are available to clients worldwide through a single platform.
- Elasticity - Does not stand out. Feedback: Not quite. Elasticity is about resources expanding or contracting in response to demand. This scenario describes shared pooled servers, not resources scaling up or down.
- Scalability - Does not stand out. Feedback: Not quite. Scalability supports long-term growth, but this scenario focuses on other features.

B. Find the evidence

Now find the evidence. Choose the sentence that best shows each feature you identified. Which sentence shows resource pooling?

- Patternmaster Strategies helps companies optimise operations through data analytics. - Not the best fit. This is background about the company. It does not describe how the platform behaves.
- Its cloud-hosted dashboards run on shared servers that balance workloads, keeping costs efficient through pooled computing resources. - Best fit. That fits. Shared servers and pooled resources balance the workloads.
- Clients worldwide get smooth performance from the same platform. - Not the best fit. This sentence shows global access: Clients in many places use the same platform.

Which sentence shows global access?

- Patternmaster Strategies helps companies optimise operations through data analytics. - Not the best fit. This is background about the company. It does not describe how the platform behaves.

- Its cloud-hosted dashboards run on shared servers that balance workloads, keeping costs efficient through pooled computing resources. - Not the best fit. This sentence shows resource pooling: Shared servers and pooled resources balance the workloads.
- Clients worldwide get smooth performance from the same platform. - Best fit. That fits. Clients in many places use the same platform.

Scenario 4 of 4: Lancre Works

Lancre Works develops a cloud-based inventory and asset-tracking platform for small retailers. As new stores join, the company steadily increases storage and processing power without rebuilding systems. It pays only for the extra capacity it uses, so growth stays affordable and spending predictable.

A. Which core cloud features stand out? Select all that apply.

- Scalability - Stands out. Feedback: That fits. The company increases its storage and processing capacity smoothly as new clients join.
- Pay-as-you-go pricing - Stands out. Feedback: That fits. The company pays only for the cloud resources it uses, which keeps expansion affordable.
- Uptime - Does not stand out. Feedback: Not quite. Uptime measures how much time a service is available. Here, the evidence is about scaling capacity for growth and paying for extra capacity used.
- Elasticity - Does not stand out. Feedback: Not quite. This case shows scalability: the company can keep increasing storage and processing power as it grows. Long-term growth is one example of scalability.

B. Find the evidence

Now find the evidence. Choose the sentence that best shows each feature you identified. Which sentence shows scalability?

- Lancre Works develops a cloud-based inventory and asset-tracking platform for small retailers. - Not the best fit. This is background about the company. It does not describe how the platform behaves.
- As new stores join, the company steadily increases storage and processing power without rebuilding systems. - Best fit. That fits. Capacity grows steadily with the business, with no rebuild.
- It pays only for the extra capacity it uses, so growth stays affordable and spending predictable. - Not the best fit. This sentence shows pay-as-you-go pricing: It pays for the extra capacity it uses and nothing more.

Which sentence shows pay-as-you-go pricing?

- Lancre Works develops a cloud-based inventory and asset-tracking platform for small retailers. - Not the best fit. This is background about the company. It does not describe how the platform behaves.
- As new stores join, the company steadily increases storage and processing power without rebuilding systems. - Not the best fit. This sentence shows scalability: Capacity grows steadily with the business, with no rebuild.
- It pays only for the extra capacity it uses, so growth stays affordable and spending predictable. - Best fit. That fits. It pays for the extra capacity it uses and nothing more.

Match the need to the feature

Customers describe needs, not features. For each statement, choose the cloud feature that meets the need most directly.

Need 1 of 4

“Our website is quiet for most of the year but gets flooded every holiday season. I do not want to pay for servers that sit idle.”

- Elasticity - Best fit. Feedback: That fits. Elasticity means: Computing power can be added or removed as demand changes, helping a service handle sudden spikes and then reduce resources afterwards.
- Scalability - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Scalability is about handling more demand by adding capacity, often for growth over time. Here, the evidence is demand that rises during the holiday season and then falls again, which fits elasticity better because resources can increase and later be reduced.
- Pay-as-you-go pricing - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Paying only for what you use is part of the benefit, but the need described is for capacity that rises and falls automatically with demand.
- Uptime - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Uptime means: Uptime is the proportion of time a service is available. Resilient design can help keep a service available when a component fails. This need is about capacity that rises and falls with demand.
- Global access - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Global access means: Customers and teams can access services from different locations and regions, where that service is provided. This need is about capacity that rises and falls with demand.
- Resource pooling - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Resource pooling means: Shared resources are used across many customers so capacity can be allocated efficiently. This need is about capacity that rises and falls with demand.

Need 2 of 4

“Our customers are in several countries, and they expect the same experience wherever they are.”

- Elasticity - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Elasticity means: Computing power can be added or removed as demand changes, helping a service handle sudden spikes and then reduce resources afterwards. This need is about serving customers in different countries through globally accessible cloud services.
- Scalability - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Scalability means: Storage and processing capacity can be increased to handle more demand, such as business growth over time. This need is about serving customers in different countries through globally accessible cloud services.
- Pay-as-you-go pricing - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Pay-as-you-go pricing means: Charges are based on the resources you use, so costs can track usage more closely than buying fixed infrastructure upfront. This need is about serving customers in different countries through globally accessible cloud services.
- Uptime - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Uptime means: Uptime is the proportion of time a service is available. Resilient design can help keep a service available when a component fails. This need is about serving customers in different countries through globally accessible cloud services.
- Global access - Best fit. Feedback: That fits. Global access means: Customers and teams can access services from different locations and regions, where that service is provided.
- Resource pooling - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Resource pooling means: Shared resources are used across many customers so capacity can be allocated efficiently. This need is about serving customers in different countries through globally accessible cloud services.

Need 3 of 4

“Our online store cannot go down during our biggest sale.”

- Elasticity - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Elasticity means: Computing power can be added or removed as demand changes, helping a service handle sudden spikes and then reduce resources afterwards. This need is about keeping the service available during critical periods such as the biggest sale.
- Scalability - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Scalability means: Storage and processing capacity can be increased to handle more demand, such as business growth over time. This need is about keeping the service available during critical periods such as the biggest sale.
- Pay-as-you-go pricing - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Pay-as-you-go pricing means: Charges are based on the resources you use, so costs can track usage more closely than buying fixed infrastructure upfront. This need is about keeping the service available during critical periods such as the biggest sale.

- Uptime - Best fit. Feedback: That fits. Uptime means: Uptime is the proportion of time a service is available. Resilient design can help keep a service available when a component fails.
- Global access - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Global access means: Customers and teams can access services from different locations and regions, where that service is provided. This need is about keeping the service available during critical periods such as the biggest sale.
- Resource pooling - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Resource pooling means: Shared resources are used across many customers so capacity can be allocated efficiently. This need is about keeping the service available during critical periods such as the biggest sale.

Need 4 of 4

“We expect to keep adding customers for years, and we do not want to rebuild our systems each time.”

- Elasticity - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Elasticity is about increasing and releasing resources to match changing demand. In this case, the evidence is ongoing growth over years and avoiding repeated rebuilds, so scalability is the better fit.
- Scalability - Best fit. Feedback: That fits. Scalability means: Storage and processing capacity can be increased to handle more demand, such as business growth over time.
- Pay-as-you-go pricing - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Pay-as-you-go pricing means: Charges are based on the resources you use, so costs can track usage more closely than buying fixed infrastructure upfront. This need is about steady growth over time without rebuilding.
- Uptime - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Uptime means: Uptime is the proportion of time a service is available. Resilient design can help keep a service available when a component fails. This need is about steady growth over time without rebuilding.
- Global access - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Global access means: Customers and teams can access services from different locations and regions, where that service is provided. This need is about steady growth over time without rebuilding.
- Resource pooling - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Resource pooling means: Shared resources are used across many customers so capacity can be allocated efficiently. This need is about steady growth over time without rebuilding.

Reflect and save

You identified the features in four scenarios and matched four customer needs. Here is a summary of the features you found.

- Jin Cloud Solutions: Elasticity and Pay-as-you-go pricing.

- Silverpath Outfitters: Uptime and Global access.
- Patternmaster Strategies: Resource pooling and Global access.
- Lancre Works: Scalability and Pay-as-you-go pricing.

Choose one feature that is easy to confuse with another, such as elasticity and scalability. In your own words, how would you explain the difference to a customer? Reflection and saving a copy are optional. You have completed the activity after identifying the features and evidence in all 4 scenarios and matching all 4 customer needs. In the interactive version, Save my summary downloads your summary; it includes your reflection if you added one. Recognising cloud features in a business situation lets you connect what the cloud does to what a customer needs.